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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: Knowledge Alliance

General Comment

Knowledge Alliance comment is attached.

Attachments

Knowledge Alliance Comments on AI RFI



March 14, 2025

Faisal D'Souza

Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordinating Office

2415 Eisenhower Avenue

Alexandria, VA 22314

Re: Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

Knowledge Alliance (KA) is pleased to respond to the Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO) National Science Foundation's (NSF) [Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence \(AI\) Action Plan](#). [Knowledge Alliance](#) is a non-profit, non-partisan organization composed of the leading education groups dedicated to empowering schools, districts and all 50 States with the tools and resources needed to improve learning and outcomes for every student.

This Request for Information seeks input from the public on the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan, as directed in an [Executive Order](#) on January 23, 2025, on policy actions "to promote human flourishing, economic competitiveness, and national security." KA appreciates the goal of "human flourishing" as part of this Action Plan and believes that equipping students, parents, and educators with the knowledge and tools to use AI effectively is an important part of this goal. In addition, maintaining a strong federal investment in education research and development is critical to growing the application and promise of AI in education to contribute to improved student outcomes and human flourishing. KA supports the development of an AI Action Plan and in particular the opportunity such a plan offers to deepen AI contributions to student learning, educator support, research, and parents' and educators' access to data to drive improved student outcomes and workforce readiness.

State education agencies (SEAs), local education agencies (LEAs), and educators are already using AI, such as D.C. Public Schools staff who partnered with the Regional Educational Laboratory (REL) Mid-Atlantic to use AI to analyze its data on Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) more efficiently to better support their students. Additionally, teachers are using AI to increase personalized learning, and students are learning about AI as a research tool. It is important that this Action Plan builds on this momentum to reach and support all interested students and educators to



engage in AI, while also supporting effective and responsible learning and use of AI in our nation's schools.

Due to our members' deep experience and involvement with district and state leaders who are exploring and testing the use of AI in education, KA is positioned to provide substantive feedback on this RFI. KA offers the following recommendations to ensure that the Action Plan considers and meets the needs of our nation's students, parents, educators, and education researchers.

Policy Topic: Application and Use

KA recommends that any application and use of AI models, either in the private sector or by government, ensure student data privacy consistent with the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) and other applicable federal laws. KA recommends the EDSAFE AI Alliance [Framework](#) as a resource in developing these safeguards to protect student data, privacy, and data quality in any AI application.

Policy Topic: Regulation and Governance

KA recommends guidance on the ethical and responsible implementation of AI in education. For example, where it is appropriate to use AI for more efficient data analysis, it is not appropriate to use AI to develop Individualized Education Plans (IEPs) for students enrolled in special education, due to the personalized nature of these plans and to account for the input and feedback of the individual student, their parents/caregivers, and education team. Guidance could include the National Institute of Standards and Technology [Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework](#), which encourages trustworthiness considerations into the design, use, and evaluation of AI products, services, and systems.

Policy Topic: Research and Development

KA encourages consultation with KA and other national organizations representing education research in the development of any policy actions on the use of AI in education research and evaluation. KA members have deep experience and expertise in education research that would inform thoughtful and responsible policy. For example, there are several kinds of education research—from quasi-experimental to randomized control trials, that all require different approaches and an understanding of them to inform any integration of AI into the research process. There is great promise in the use of AI to enhance education research, development, and dissemination that can lead to improved student outcomes, and should be done in a way to empower researchers to drive that process.

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Policy Topic: Education and Workforce

KA encourages ED to issue guidance on eligible federal funding and best practices to promote AI training and literacy for students, parents, educators, LEAs, and SEAs. The Regional Educational Laboratories (RELs) and Comprehensive Centers (CCs) are ideal partners for this kind of capacity-building with States, districts, and educators on anything from building evidence on the uses of AI in education to using generative AI for more efficient data analysis at the district or state level to learning effective instructional practices to help students use AI responsibly.

Policy Topic: Innovation and Competition

In order for the U.S. education system to stay innovative and globally competitive, the federal government must maintain a strong investment in education research and development through the Institute of Education Sciences (IES) at ED to foster the research and application of AI in learning and to prepare students for the workforce involving AI. These investments must also include programs like the Regional Educational Laboratories (RELs) that generate research, evidence and tools for States to implement to improve student outcomes and are driven by States' and districts' expressed priorities. RELs are positioned to support States and districts to use AI to improve student outcomes, as the REL Mid-Atlantic did through working with DCPS to use generative AI to analyze its data on Multi-Tiered Systems of Supports (MTSS). Another critical federal program that can accelerate educators' AI literacy and use is the Comprehensive Centers (CCs) grant program that, like the RELs, work with all 50 states and U.S. territories. The CCs help States and districts identify, implement and sustain effective evidence-based practices that support improved educator and student outcomes and adapt their work based on State and district needs and desire for innovative approaches including AI. Additionally, KA recommends strong investment in the Education Innovation and Research (EIR) Grant Program and as a vehicle to include as a priority for applicants the use of AI to enhance student learning. EIR grants provide funding to create, develop, implement, replicate, or take to scale entrepreneurial, evidence-based, field-initiated innovations to improve student outcomes. The EIR program consists of three different types of grants (*early, mid-phase and expansion grants*) that allocate increased investments as the level of evidence increases—an efficient and smart investment of Federal funds. In addition to these investments in IES, KA recommends strengthening funding at NSF for education-related research that can advance innovations in AI to support educators and students in teaching and learning.

Policy Topic: Model Development

KA recommends that the AI Action Plan put in place safeguards in the development of AI models to prevent or mitigate bias that has been detected in current AI models. For example, a 2023 [Stanford University study](#) found that generative AI models such as ChatGPT often falsely identify non-native



English writing as AI generated. Education researchers can support the testing of AI models to detect and protect against this kind of bias before it is used by students and educators.

Conclusion

KA supports the development of an AI Action Plan that can improve student outcomes, empower researchers, and support parents, educators, and policymakers with more efficient ways to learn how students are doing and how we can best support them to succeed. Thank you for the opportunity to provide input on this Action Plan and please do not hesitate to reach out if you have any questions or if there is anything we can do to help.

Sincerely,

Rachel Dinkes
President and CEO
Knowledge Alliance